8.1 Intro and terminology

In this subsection, I will first walk you through a motivational example, showing the power of distributed tracing. Then, I will define terminology used throughout the chapter.

8.1.1 Motivational example

To set the scene, let's start off by having a look at a concrete example of a microservices-based application that serves as a motivation. Figure 8.1 shows such an example app. It's a simplified version of an e-commerce app that allows end users to browse and search for items, order them, and have them shipped. To be a little more concrete, imagine you're building an e-commerce app that allows you to shop telescopes, akin to the walk-through example we will cover in the appendix.

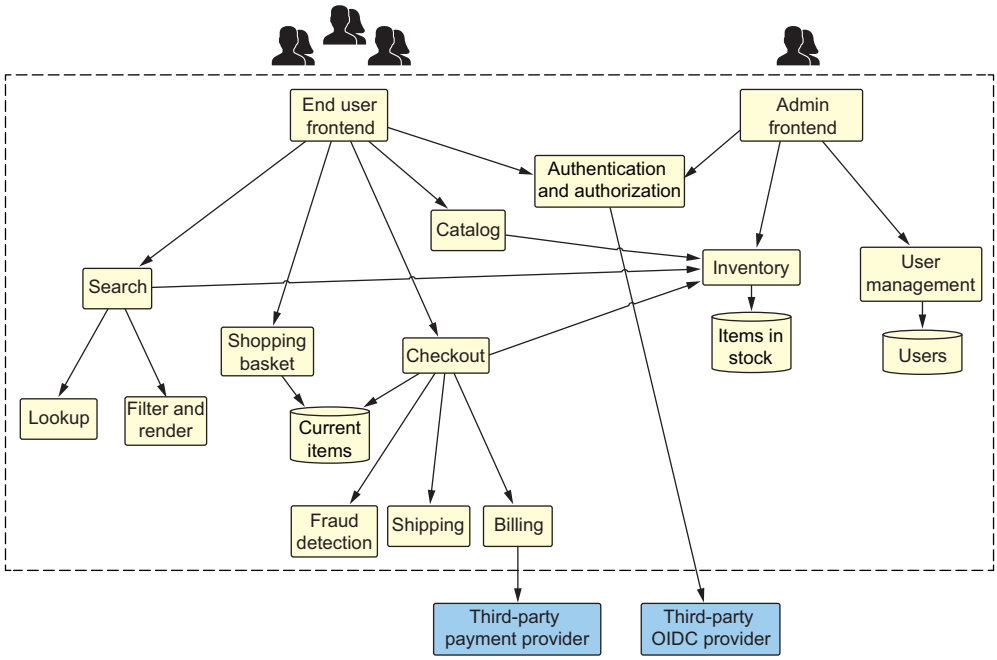


Figure 8.1 An example microservices-based e-commerce app (within the dotted box)

In our e-commerce example app, we have two logical parts, with some of the functionality, such as the payment details, provided by external (third-party) services and some (authentication) shared between these logical blocks (with the dotted box being our web app).

The left-hand side of figure 8.1 shows the end user–serving (customer) part, implementing features like searching for an item and allowing end users to add items to a